

On the move

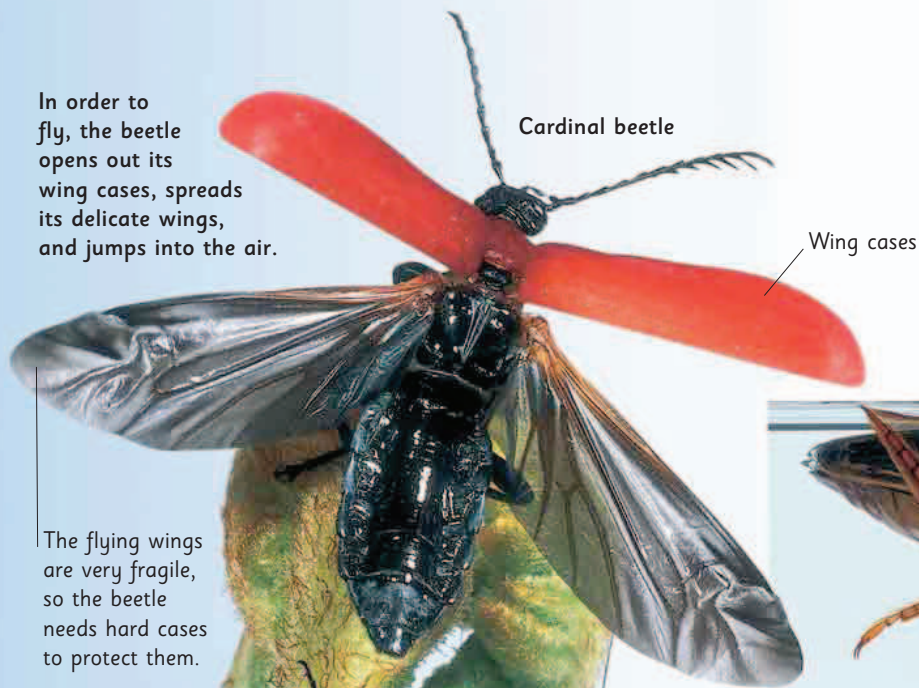
Insects are very good at moving around. Many run, others fly, some jump, and a few even swim!

Flying

All flying insects have two pairs of wings, but they use them in different ways. Beetles fly with one pair while the second, harder pair folds over the top to protect them.

In order to fly, the beetle opens out its wing cases, spreads its delicate wings, and jumps into the air.

The flying wings are very fragile, so the beetle needs hard cases to protect them.



Other wings

Here are some more ways insects use their wings. Many are very good air acrobats.



Housefly: flies only use one pair of wings. The other pair look like sticks.



Dragonfly: it uses both pairs and can operate each side separately.

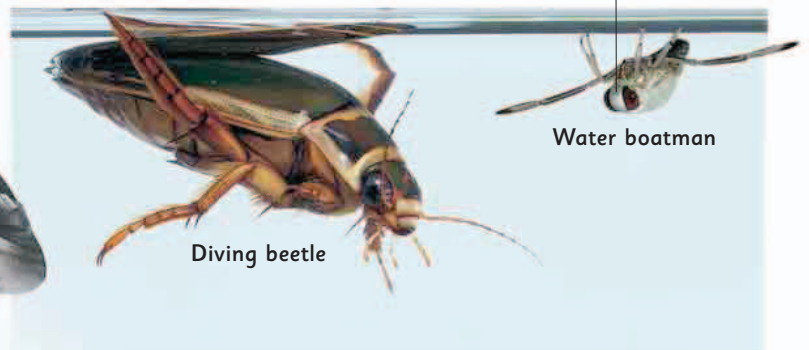


Lacewing: this insect can use four wings separately and can fly backwards.



Hoverfly: the hoverfly beats its wings so fast you can barely see them.

This water boatman hangs upside down beneath the surface.



Diving beetle

Water boatman

Swimming

Some insects spend much of their time under water, using their legs like paddles. Diving beetles have special hairs on their legs that splay out in the water and help them swim.

Caterpillars can loop up steep twigs.